

Maria Silva

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LLB and LLM graduate with a year of practical experience supporting complex international arbitration and real estate disputes at BCLP, alongside ongoing case management and client advisory work at Citizens Advice. Experienced in organising case files, preparing court and hearing materials, tracking procedural deadlines, managing confidential documents and coordinating across teams under time pressure. Strong written communication and organisational skills, with a clear focus on commercial litigation support.

EDUCATION

Comparative and International Dispute Resolution LLM — Merit

Sept 2024 – Oct 2025

Queen Mary University of London

- Modules in international arbitration, dispute resolution procedure, legal research and evidence analysis
- Transnational Law and Governance Applied module (data privacy and democracy) — 75%
- Dissertation: comparative development of GDPR across jurisdictions

Law LLB — 2:1

Sept 2020 – June 2024

University College London

- Alternative Dispute Resolution, Advanced Contract Law, Commercial Law, Company Law

International Foundation Programme of Law and International Relations

Sept 2019 – June 2020

King's College London

- Awarded the Leaders of Tomorrow prize (top 20 of a 200-student cohort; partial funding toward undergraduate degree)

EXPERIENCE

Bryan Cave Leighton Paisner LLP (BCLP) · London

Aug 2023 – Feb 2024

Legal Placement Student — International Arbitration

- Supported a complex investment arbitration: reviewed and organised evidence for procedural submissions and the Claimant's memorial; drafted procedural orders and procedural histories
- Became the only junior supporting the team shortly before a major submission deadline: coordinated documents, tracked outstanding actions and helped ensure on-time filing
- Maintained structured electronic case files and monitored procedural deadlines throughout the matter
- Liaised with the client on required documents; coordinated Romanian translations with an external translator
- Received feedback from a partner and associate that performance was comparable to a newly qualified solicitor

Bryan Cave Leighton Paisner LLP (BCLP) · London

Feb 2024 – Aug 2024

Legal Placement Student — Real Estate Disputes

- Supported hearing preparation: reviewed documents, prepared electronic bundles and assisted with skeleton arguments and court materials
- Managed court filings, hearing arrangements, and matter opening and closure across several concurrent matters
- Tracked deadlines and maintained matter records via iManage; handled large volumes of confidential documents under competing time pressures
- Conducted legal and factual research on rights of light, easements, leasehold issues and landlord and tenant disputes
- Assisted with cost comparisons and prepared client notes

Citizens Advice East Berkshire · Maidenhead

July 2026 – Present

Legal Adviser

- Manages a varied caseload from initial instruction through to submission: drafts correspondence, prepares applications and document schedules, maintains confidential case records and meets regulatory deadlines
- Interviews clients, takes detailed factual statements, establishes chronologies and identifies relevant legal and evidential issues across welfare, housing, employment, family and debt matters
- Advises clients on procedural requirements and options, translating complex rules into clear, practical guidance

Q-Legal · London

Oct 2024 – Jan 2025

Legal Adviser

- Managed a data-privacy matter from client instruction through to a formal written advice letter, under a qualified solicitor's supervision
- Researched UK GDPR and Data Protection Act 2018 obligations for a data-driven start-up; identified compliance risks and recommended practical mitigations
- Coordinated with the client and supervising solicitor to meet the deadline and deliver commercially focused advice

Adobe · London

June 2022 – Aug 2022

Legal Intern

- Reviewed and amended software licensing agreements; identified contractual risks and assessed alignment with internal legal and compliance requirements
- Liaised with sales, legal and international business teams to resolve contractual queries and communicate amendments to stakeholders
- Prepared and delivered an internal presentation on breach-of-contract risks and mitigation measures

SKILLS

Languages: Portuguese (native), English (fluent), Spanish (basic)

Technical skills: Microsoft Word, Excel and PowerPoint; iManage; legal research databases; electronic court filing portals; electronic bundling; document review; case management and time-recording systems

Case and evidence management: Hearing bundle preparation, procedural histories, evidence review, case-file organisation, deadline tracking across concurrent matters